decision is taken, the effective date should be many months or years away. This reduces the extent to which the policy decision induces instability.

Too often, we see a big policy change that was planned in secrecy, and then there is an uproar, and then we get a policy reversal. It would have been much better to have done the developmental work in the public eye. Sometimes, the early feedback would have been so negative that the decision may never have been taken. In general, people react better when they are adequately sensitized.

Revolutionary change for government

When it comes to society, we should respect every person going about her daily life in a stable way based on her own search for happiness. Policymakers should not be the source of upheavals, of crises, of disruption.

A very different approach is required when it comes to redesigning *government systems*. As policymakers, we should be quite willing to ask civil servants to do new things. There is no need to respect the stability of the life of a civil servant. There is a need to constantly redesign organizations, rearrange turf, design better operating procedures, etc., to push public bodies to higher levels of performance.

As a thumb rule, each doubling of GDP (in real terms) calls for a fairly far-reaching change in the organization structure of government. It calls for a substantial rethinking of the boundaries and functions of departments and agencies, and of government processes. In India, most of the organization design seen today dates back to the time when India had one-tenth of the present GDP. Greater energy is called for, in organization design in government.

We should prioritize the good night's sleep of the populace but not of civil servants. [1] We should pursue revolutionary change for government structures, but evolutionary change for the people.

It is when the state interacts with private persons—either by coercing them or by setting up an expenditure programme—that we should be